

EXODUS IN SUDAN
AFTER U.S. USHERS
ENVOYS TO SAFETY

OTHER NATIONS FOLLOW

Century of Calm Gone —
Western Negotiators
Face Criticism

This article is by **Declan Walsh**, **Charlie Savage** and **Eric Schmitt**.

NAIROBI, Kenya — It began with a helicopter evacuation of American diplomats from Sudan’s capital city just after midnight Sunday, then turned into a full-fledged exodus of foreign officials and citizens of other nations as the battle raged around them.

At the United States Embassy in Khartoum, an elite team of Navy SEALs ushered up to 90 people onto aircraft before taking off for Djibouti, 800 miles away.

Hours later, a United Nations convoy began snaking its way out of the city, starting a 525-mile drive to Port Sudan on the Red Sea, while British and French diplomats were escorted to an airfield outside the city where military cargo planes were waiting. Other groups headed for Qadarif, a small town near the border with Ethiopia, and a boat chartered by Saudi Arabia carried its fleeing diplomats across the Red Sea.

After days of fruitless diplomatic efforts to get two warring Sudanese generals to lay down their weapons, foreign governments took another tack this weekend: fleeing a country, long viewed as strategically important, that has been in the grip of intense fighting for over a week.

Emotions were raw. Some Sudanese, feeling angry and abandoned, lashed out Sunday at the Western negotiators they blame for the disastrous collapse of talks that were supposed to lead to civilian rule, but instead became a flashpoint for the two generals now battling for power.

Foreign officials, some say, went too far to appease the generals, treating them nearly as statesmen when in fact the two men seized power in a coup and have long records of abuses and deception. Some Sudanese fear that now, the exit of foreign diplomats might allow an even more brutal turn in the nation’s affairs.

“You put us in this mess and now you’re swooping in to take

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MOHAMED NURELDIN ABDALLAH/REUTERS



MARWAN ALI/ASSOCIATED PRESS



ABUBAKARR JALLOH/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE — GETTY IMAGES

From top, carrying water during clashes on Saturday between the paramilitary Rapid Support Forces and the Sudanese army in Khartoum North. Khartoum, Sudan’s capital, was the starting point for a huge convoy headed to Port Sudan organized by the United Nations.

China Censors
Are Thwarting
Covid Science

Targeting International
Data and Journals

By **MARA HVISTENDAHL** and **BENJAMIN MUELLER**

Early in 2020, on the same day that a frightening new illness officially got the name Covid-19, a team of scientists from the United States and China released critical data showing how quickly the virus was spreading, and who was dying.

The study was cited in health warnings around the world and appeared to be a model of international collaboration in a moment of crisis.

Within days, though, the researchers quietly withdrew the paper, which was replaced online by a message telling scientists not to cite it. A few observers took note of the peculiar move, but the whole episode quickly faded amid the frenzy of the coronavirus pandemic.

What is now clear is that the study was not removed because of faulty research. Instead, it was withdrawn at the direction of Chinese health officials amid a crackdown on science. That effort kicked up a cloud of dust around the dates of early Covid cases, like those reported in the study.

“It was so hard to get any information out of China,” said one of the authors, Ira Longini, of the University of Florida, who described the back story of the removal publicly for the first time in a recent interview. “There was so much covered up, and so much hidden.”

That the Chinese government muzzled scientists, hindered international investigations and censored online discussion of the pandemic is well documented. But Beijing’s stranglehold on information goes far deeper than even many pandemic researchers are aware of. Its censorship campaign has targeted international journals and scientific databases, shaking the foundations of shared scientific knowledge, a New York Times investigation found.

Under pressure from their government, Chinese scientists have withheld data, withdrawn genetic sequences from public databases and altered crucial details in journal submissions. Western journal editors enabled those efforts by agreeing to those edits or withdrawing papers for murky reasons, a review by The Times of over a dozen retracted papers found.

Groups including the World Health Organization have given credence to muddled data and inaccurate timelines.

This scientific censorship has not universally succeeded: The original version of the February 2020 paper, for example, can still be found online with some digging. But the campaign starved

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BIDEN IS OPENING
LEGAL PATHWAYS
FOR IMMIGRATION

BACK-DOOR MEASURES

In Humanitarian Policy,
Critics See Usurping
of Congress’s Role

By **MIRIAM JORDAN**

Amid a protracted stalemate in Congress over immigration, President Biden has opened a back door to allow hundreds of thousands of new immigrants into the country, significantly expanding the use of humanitarian parole programs for people escaping war and political turmoil around the world.

The measures, introduced over the past year to offer refuge to people fleeing Ukraine, Haiti and Latin America, offer immigrants the opportunity to fly to the United States and quickly secure work authorization, provided they have a private sponsor to take responsibility for them.

As of mid-April, some 300,000 Ukrainians had arrived in the United States under various programs — a number greater than all the people from around the world admitted through the official U.S. refugee program in the last five years.

By the end of 2023, about 360,000 Venezuelans, Cubans, Nicaraguans and Haitians are expected to gain admission through a similar private sponsorship initiative introduced in January to stem unauthorized crossings at the southern border — more people than were issued immigrant visas from these countries in the last 15 years combined.

The Biden administration has also greatly expanded the number of people who are in the United States with what is known as temporary protected status, a program former President Donald J. Trump had sought to terminate. About 670,000 people from 16 countries have had their protections extended or become newly eligible since Mr. Biden took office, according to a new report from the Pew Research Center.

All told, these temporary humanitarian programs could become the largest expansion of legal immigration in decades.

“The longer Congress goes without legislating anything on immigration, the more the executive branch will do what it can within its own power based on the president’s principles,” said Theresa Cardinal Brown, senior adviser at the Bipartisan Policy Center in Washington.

The main challenge, she noted, is that “the courts can come in and say it’s outside the president’s authority, or an abuse of discretion, and take it all away.”

Already, critics have com-

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Government Workers Are Enabling Putin’s War

By **ANATOLY KURMANAEV**

CAIRO — Soon after his airplane took off from Moscow last fall, a Russian energy official who had just resigned took his phone and typed up the emotions he had kept bottled inside since the invasion of Ukraine.

“I am tired of feeling constant fear for myself, for my loved ones, for the future of my country and of my own,” Arseny Pogosyan wrote on his social media page as he flew into a hurried exile. “I am against this inhumane war.”

The outburst in September did

Many Feel Obligation
to Stay in Jobs, But
Others Have Fled

not receive much attention, gathering eight likes and one brief comment. After all, Mr. Pogosyan, 30, was among the hundreds of thousands of young Russian men fleeing the mobilization announced days earlier by President Vladimir V. Putin to replenish his battered military.

But among his colleagues in the energy ministry, where he worked as a press officer, his decision to leave his job was rare.

Since the war began, Russia has lost droves of tech workers as well as other professionals, a brain drain that analysts say will harm the country’s economy for decades. By contrast, many government employees have fallen in line behind Mr. Putin’s wartime leadership. Almost all senior Russian technocrats and a large majority of their immediate subordinates — officials who guide Russia’s economy — remain in their

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Bed Bath Chain
To Start Process
Of Closing Shop

By **JORDYN HOLMAN** and **LAUREN HIRSCH**

Bed Bath & Beyond came out of the 2008 downturn a winner. While competitors like Sharper Image and Linens ’n Things filed for bankruptcy, Bed Bath & Beyond actually expanded its business by acquiring other retailers. Its home-goods emporiums full of towels and kitchen aids — all available at a reduced price with that Big Blue coupon — were beacons that kept shoppers coming back.

Now, as the U.S. economy experiences another period of uncertainty, Bed Bath & Beyond is no longer on top, the result of an increasingly unwieldy corporate structure and its failure to fully reckon with the ascendance of on-line shopping.

On Sunday, the 52-year-old retailer said it was filing for bankruptcy protection in United States Bankruptcy Court for the District of New Jersey. It said it would start the process of closing the

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New G.O.P. Tactic: Keep Abortion Off the Ballot

By **KATE ZERNIKE** and **MICHAEL WINES**

Voters pushed back decisively after the Supreme Court overturned Roe v. Wade last year, approving ballot measures that established or upheld abortion rights in all six states where they appeared.

Now, with abortion rights groups pushing for similar citizen-

States Hinder Initiatives
Led by Citizens

led ballot initiatives in at least six other states, Republican-controlled legislatures and anti-abortion groups are trying to stay one step ahead by making it harder to pass the measures — or to get

them on the ballot at all.

The biggest and most immediate fight is in Ohio, where a coalition of abortion rights groups is collecting signatures to place a constitutional amendment on the ballot in November that would prohibit the state from banning abortion before a fetus becomes viable outside the womb, at about 24 weeks of pregnancy. That

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MATTHEW CHILDS/REUTERS

A Marathon of Marvels

Sifan Hassan triumphed in London in a stunning comeback, and Kelvin Kiptum won the men’s race in nearly record time. Page D3.

NATIONAL A10-17

More Limits on Treatment

States are trying to restrict gender care for adults, from Medicaid bans to Missouri’s sweeping rules. PAGE A15

A Death in Dairyland

After Brenda Statz’s farmer husband, Leon, died by suicide, she took action to spare others from his fate. PAGE A14



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A Pall Over Israel’s Ceremonies

Israelis are bracing for a tense Memorial Day and the 75th anniversary of their country’s founding as a political crisis tears it apart. PAGE A4

Finland’s Secret to Happiness

The Nordic country has been ranked the happiest country on earth for six consecutive years. PAGE A6

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Uplifting Female Scientists

Elizabeth Wagner Reed dedicated her career to supporting women in the field. Overlooked. PAGE B6

BUSINESS B1-4

NBCUniversal C.E.O. Leaving

Jeff Shell had been under investigation for having “an inappropriate relationship with a woman,” the company’s owner, Comcast, said. PAGE B1

Kicking the Tires on E.V.s

Buying an electric car has become more complicated because of restrictions on which models qualify for a federal tax credit of up to \$7,500. PAGE B1

Lesson Learned? Probably Not.

There is little reason to think Fox News will adjust its coverage after paying a \$787.5 million defamation settlement to Dominion Voting Systems. PAGE B1

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The Unknown Podcaster

A host in Ireland says that keeping his face covered lets him say things he couldn’t otherwise. PAGE C1

A Tour-de-Force Stage Debut

“Prima Facie” puts the misogyny of male barristers in sexual assault cases on trial. A review by Jesse Green. PAGE C1



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Hip Hip Hip Hip Hip Hooray

All five pro winter season teams in the New York area reached the playoffs for the first time since 1994. PAGE D1

Soccer on a Sliver of Africa

The Spanish club A.D. Ceuta sits at a crossroads where Spain, Morocco and migrants come together. PAGE D6

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Linda Greenhouse

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